

# Maheswari P

Team Lead – SEO, BankBazaar | Organic Growth & AI Automation

## CASE STUDY 1

### Recovering 18% Organic Traffic by Fixing Duplicate Content Across 8,000+ IFSC Pages

Focus Area: Technical SEO · Canonicalisation · Site Architecture

#### The Challenge

BankBazaar's IFSC code lookup section had grown to more than 8,000 near-identical bank-branch pages. Each page followed a similar template with only branch-level details changing, which search engines increasingly treated as duplicate or thin content. Google was inconsistently indexing and ranking these pages, splitting authority across near-duplicate URLs, and organic traffic to this high-volume section had begun to decline.

#### My Approach

- Audited the full IFSC URL set to identify duplicate, near-duplicate, and thin-content patterns using crawl data from Search Console and internal log files.
- Mapped canonical relationships across the 8,000+ URLs, identifying the authoritative version for each duplicate cluster.
- Implemented canonical tags at scale and restructured the URL hierarchy for clearer, more logical groupings by state, bank, and branch.
- Improved internal linking between related IFSC pages to consolidate link equity and support crawl efficiency.
- Monitored indexation status and crawl budget allocation in Search Console throughout the rollout to catch regressions early.

#### Tools Used

Google Search Console, Google Analytics, canonical tag implementation, internal log file analysis, URL restructuring.

#### Results

Within 60 days of rolling out the canonicalisation and URL restructuring, organic traffic to the affected section recovered and grew by 18%. Crawl budget was redirected toward the canonical, authoritative pages, and indexation of duplicate variants dropped sharply — freeing up crawl capacity for other high-value sections of the site.

#### Key Takeaway

At scale, duplicate content isn't just a ranking issue — it's a crawl-budget and indexation issue. Fixing it required thinking in terms of URL architecture and canonical signals across thousands of pages at once, not one-off page edits.

## CASE STUDY 2

### Winning AI Overviews — AEO/GEO Restructuring for Google AI, ChatGPT & Perplexity Citations

Focus Area: Answer Engine Optimisation (AEO) · Generative Engine Optimisation (GEO) · Structured Data

#### The Challenge

As search behaviour shifted toward AI-driven answers — Google AI Overviews, ChatGPT, and Perplexity — BankBazaar's product pages, written primarily for traditional blue-link SERPs, were not being surfaced or cited in AI-generated responses. Competitors with more structured, entity-rich content were increasingly appearing as the cited source for financial product queries, putting BankBazaar's organic visibility for high-intent, top-of-funnel queries at risk.

#### My Approach

- Audited top commercial and informational pages across Credit Cards, Loans, Insurance, and Savings to identify gaps between existing content and how AI engines extract and cite answers.
- Restructured key pages around clear, entity-based content blocks and direct-answer formatting that AI systems could parse and cite easily.
- Implemented FAQPage, FinancialProduct, BreadcrumbList, and HowTo structured data sitewide to strengthen entity relationships and earn rich results.
- Rewrote high-priority FAQ and comparison sections to directly answer common user questions in concise, extractable language.
- Tracked citation appearances in Google AI Overviews, ChatGPT, and Perplexity manually and via prompt-based monitoring to validate impact.

#### Tools Used

FAQPage / FinancialProduct / BreadcrumbList / HowTo schema markup, Google Search Console, content architecture redesign, manual AI-citation tracking.

#### Results

Following the restructuring, BankBazaar's product and informational pages began appearing as cited sources within Google AI Overviews, ChatGPT, and Perplexity responses for target financial queries — establishing an early foothold in AI-driven search discovery alongside continued growth in traditional organic visibility (5M+ monthly organic visitors sitewide).

#### Key Takeaway

Ranking in traditional SERPs and being cited by AI answer engines require overlapping but distinct signals. Structured data and entity clarity earn the crawl and comprehension; concise, direct-answer content earns the citation.